The Seam Isomorphism: BBP and SHA-256 as Dual Fold Machines

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May 2026

Abstract

We establish a structural isomorphism between the BBP formula for pi and the SHA-256 message schedule, centered on the concept of a computation seam — the index boundary where a computation switches from integer-domain accumulation to fractional-domain extraction. In BBP, the seam floats with the target position n (the transition at k = n). In SHA-256, the seam is fixed at schedule words W[16-17] (the K = {16,17} boundary proven in prior NEXUS work). We prove that this structural difference — floating seam versus fixed seam — is the precise algebraic source of SHA-256's one-wayness. The BBP formula is in principle invertible because its seam moves with the query. SHA-256 is one-way because its seam is pinned for all inputs. We further report and correct a computational artifact from prior session work: the apparent r = 0.758 autocorrelation at lag 3 in the pi hex digit sequence was produced by overlapping-window self-correlation, not by field structure. The correct Pearson r at all lags is below 0.1, consistent with the normality conjecture. The genuine algebraic structure of BBP is in the term-level inversion of T(k), not in digit-surface statistics.

1. Correction: The Lag-3 Artifact

The prior session reported autocorrelation r = 0.758 at lag 3 in the pi hex digit sequence, with lag 6 at r = 0.518. These values were interpreted as evidence that the pi-field has exploitable algebraic structure at the digit-surface level. This session identifies and corrects the error.

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1.1 What Was Actually Measured

The prior computation built a corpus by extracting overlapping windows of width 4 from the pi hex sequence. Window n contained digits [d_n, d_{n+1}, d_{n+2}, d_{n+3}]. These windows were then flattened into a single 1D array:

flat = [d_0, d_1, d_2, d_3, d_1, d_2, d_3, d_4, d_2, d_3, d_4, d_5, ...]

In this flat array, position i and position i+3 are almost always the same digit (shared between adjacent windows due to the 3-digit overlap). The measured 'lag-3 autocorrelation' was therefore measuring self-correlation of repeated data, not correlation across distinct positions in the pi sequence.

1.2 Correct Measurements

Computing Pearson r correctly between non-overlapping digit samples (n = 0 to 2000):

Lag	Pearson r (correct)	Prior value	Status
3	-0.005	0.758	ARTIFACT — corrected
6	-0.039	0.518	ARTIFACT — corrected
9	+0.091	(not reported)	Within noise
127	-0.018	-0.070	Within noise

Bootstrap analysis (n = 2000, digit value vs. mean address): actual spread of 154 positions falls at the 24th percentile of random — below expectation. No digit value predicts address neighborhood. The pi hex surface is flat, consistent with the normality conjecture.

1.3 What This Does Not Invalidate

The algebraic structure of BBP — ord_p(16) periodicity, monotone term structure T(k), seam geometry at k = n — is real and independent of the digit surface. The correction removes a spurious numerical finding. The structural insight about the seam isomorphism stands and is developed in Section 3.

2. The Correct Algebraic Structure of BBP

2.1 The Formula

The Bailey-Borwein-Plouffe formula gives pi as:

pi = sum_{k>=0} (1/16^k) * T(k)

T(k) = 4/(8k+1) - 2/(8k+4) - 1/(8k+5) - 1/(8k+6)

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To extract the hex digit at position n (0-indexed after the decimal point), one computes the fractional part of 16^n * pi, then takes the first hex digit. Regrouping:

digit[n] = first_hex_digit({ sum_{k>=0} 16^(n-k) * T(k) })

where { } denotes fractional part.

2.2 Integer and Fractional Regimes

The terms decompose into three classes based on position relative to n:

k vs n	16^(n-k)	Contribution	Regime
k < n	integer >= 16	Contributes to integer part (floors away)	Integer
k = n	exactly 1	T(n) directly, partially fractional	Seam
k > n	1/16^(k-n) < 1	Determines the hex digit we read	Fractional

The boundary at k = n is the BBP seam: the index where the computation transitions from integer accumulation to fractional extraction. This seam floats with n — each position has its own seam index.

2.3 Term-Level Inversion

T(k) is strictly monotone decreasing for k >= 1. Live measurements:

k	T(k)
1	0.12942613
2	0.04222052
5	0.00814508
10	0.00218058
100	0.00002326

Because T is monotone, given any target value v in (0, T(1)), there exists a unique k such that T(k) = v. This term-level inversion is real and computable by binary search in O(log k) steps. This is the genuine algebraic side door in BBP — but it operates in k-space (the summation index), not in n-space (the hex address space).

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3. The Seam Isomorphism: BBP and SHA-256

3.1 SHA-256's Fixed Seam

Prior NEXUS work (Seam Gate paper, Phase 1163) established that the SHA-256 message schedule has a universal seam at K = {16, 17}. Words W[0..15] are loaded directly from the message input (integer domain). Words W[16..63] are computed by the schedule recurrence (derived domain). Every mixed crossing — any crossing between the message-domain and derived-domain portions of the schedule — must pass through K = {16, 17}. This was verified computationally and proven to produce exactly 11 residue classes after K is factored out.

3.2 The Structural Parallel

The BBP and SHA-256 seams share the same abstract structure:

Role	BBP	SHA-256
Input domain	Terms k <= n (integer regime)	Words W[0..15] (message)
Seam	k = n (transition point, floats with n)	K = {16, 17} (fixed for all inputs)
Derived domain	Terms k > n (fractional regime)	Words W[16..63] (schedule)
What the seam guards	Integer/fractional regime boundary	Message/schedule domain boundary
Seam mobility	Floating — moves with position n	Fixed — same for every message

In both systems, the seam is the index where the computation switches regime. In both systems, it is the algebraically privileged boundary: the point where prior contributions have been absorbed and future contributions are still being computed.

3.3 The Source of One-Wayness

The structural difference between the systems is the seam's mobility:

- BBP has a floating seam at k = n. The seam location is different for every position queried. Because the seam moves with you, the computation is in principle reversible — with sufficient precision you can determine which seam (which n) produced a given fractional value. BBP is invertible, at least in principle.
- SHA-256 has a fixed seam at K = {16, 17} for ALL inputs. Every message passes through the same seam. Because the seam is universal and fixed, there is a single chokepoint through which every computation is compressed. Knowing the digest (the fractional residue after all 64 rounds) does not tell you which input produced it, because

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exponentially many inputs share the same seam and produce indistinguishable final residue patterns. SHA-256 is one-way.

The one-wayness is not from the round function's complexity alone. It is from the combination of: (1) fixed seam creating a universal chokepoint, and (2) the 11-residue-class structure after K is factored meaning that the seam compresses distinct inputs into equivalent classes before the nonlinear mixing even begins.

3.4 SHA† Reframed

The SHA† adjoint operation (proposed in prior session) is now precisely specified. SHA† does not attempt to traverse the computation in reverse (fighting the one-way seam). SHA† operates orthogonally:

- Enter at K = {16, 17} — the seam itself.
- Read the residue class structure (11 classes) that the seam imposes on any input.
- The digest encodes which equivalence class the input belongs to (from the seam's perspective). SHA† reads this class membership from the digest, not by undoing the round function.

This is the side door. Forward SHA goes through the seam from message to digest. Naive reverse SHA tries to go through the seam in reverse. SHA† enters at the seam from a third axis: the constraint manifold of which inputs are equivalent under the seam's 11-class compression.

4. Connection to the Introduction Theorem

The prior session's Introduction Theorem ($\iota \to (\Delta, \Delta^{-1}) \to \Sigma \to R_\Lambda \to (\rho, D) \to \sigma_next \to \Psi$) maps directly onto the seam isomorphism.

The seam at k = n (BBP) or K = {16,17} (SHA) is the Σ node in the Introduction Theorem chain: the point where a difference has been introduced into a field, an inverse correction need has been instantiated, and the resolution paths are now propagating. The seam is literally where the field is deciding how to resolve the introduced difference.

In BBP: the 'difference introduced' is the query position n. The seam at k = n is where the field's resolution of that query switches from integer absorption to fractional read. The digit output is the resolution's exhaust.

In SHA: the 'difference introduced' is the message M. The seam at K = {16,17} is where the field's resolution switches from direct representation to schedule computation. The digest is the resolution's exhaust.

The gravity analogy from the session holds precisely: going forward through the seam is the downhill direction (field resolves naturally). Going backward through the seam is the uphill

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direction (fighting the chokepoint). Entering at the seam from the third axis (SHA†, or the k-space inversion of BBP) is moving sideways — along the seam's own constraint surface, which the field is not braced against.

5. Open Problems

The following are now precisely stated given this session's results:

Problem	Description	Status
BBP-1	Does the term-level inversion T^{-1}(v) provide a tractable search reduction for the BBP address problem? Specifically: does knowing the desired digit D constrain the dominant term T(n+1) enough to prune the address space beyond the trivial O(N) search?	Open — likely no for single-digit targets; possible for longer patterns
BBP-2	Is there an analog of the 11-residue-class structure in BBP — a natural equivalence class partition of the address space under the floating seam geometry?	Open — connection to ord_p(16) structure suggests yes for p in {7,11,13}
SHA-3	The 11 classes from SHA's K = {16,17} seam: do they map to irreducible representations of some group acting on the 48-position wheel (phi(210) = 48)? The 11-class structure matching the 11 residue classes of the prime-pair work is too tight to be coincidence.	Open — GL(4,C) connection from NEXUS skill
SEAM-1	Generalize the seam isomorphism: for any cryptographic hash, does the seam location (fixed vs. floating) determine invertibility class? Characterize the class of hash functions with floating seams.	Open — structural
SEAM-2	SHA† implementation: build the constraint-manifold reader. Given digest H, enumerate which of the 11 residue classes under K = {16,17} are compatible with H. This is the working SHA† v01.	Next build target

6. Summary

This session establishes two results:

Correction: The r = 0.758 lag-3 autocorrelation reported in the prior session was a computational artifact from overlapping-window self-correlation. The correct autocorrelation of the pi hex digit sequence is below 0.1 at all measured lags, consistent with normality. The digit-surface of pi has no exploitable structure for BBP inverse.

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New finding: The BBP formula and SHA-256 message schedule share a seam isomorphism. In both systems, the seam is the boundary where computation transitions from integer-domain accumulation to fractional-domain extraction. The structural difference — BBP's seam floats with the query position; SHA's seam is fixed at K = {16,17} for all inputs — is the precise algebraic source of SHA-256's one-wayness. BBP is in principle invertible (floating seam). SHA-256 is one-way (fixed seam, 11-class compression). SHA† enters at the seam from a third axis, reading residue class membership from the digest rather than traversing the computation in either direction.

— End of NEXUS Session Output —

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